Liuya Zhang

Ph.D. Candidate, Department of Political Science, The Ohio State University
International Relations and Political Methodology; Comparative Politics minor
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Education

The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH 2020–Expected May 2027
Ph.D. candidate in Political Science, International Relations and Political Methodology

Dissertation/book project: *In the Shadows of Imperialism: Postcolonial National Habitus, Identity, and Foreign Policy Orientation*. Committee: Christopher Gelpi and Jennifer Mitzen, co-chairs; Alexander Wendt; Jan Pierskalla.

University of California, San Diego, La Jolla, CA 2018–2020
M.A. in International Affairs, Korea and China specialization

Seoul National University, Seoul, South Korea 2015–2018
M.A. in Area Studies, China specialization

Thesis on China-Korea relations under Xi Jinping, focusing on THAAD, the U.S. Asia rebalance, and the North Korean nuclear issue. Advisor: Young Nam Cho.

Fudan University, Shanghai, China 2011–2015
B.A. in Korean Language and Literature

Exchange study at Kyung Hee University, 2012; summer study at Korea University, 2015.

Research and Teaching Interests

International relations theory; postcolonial and decolonial international relations; identity, hierarchy, and recognition politics; public opinion and foreign policy analysis; Asia-Pacific international relations; computational text analysis; mixed methods.

Manuscripts and Publications

Peer-Reviewed Manuscripts

Zhang, Liuya, and Haoming Xiong. "China's Recognition Dilemma: Development-Oriented Conformity, Nationalist Assertion, and Foreign Policy Discourse, 1978–2021." Revise & Resubmit, *The Chinese Journal of International Politics*. (First and corresponding author)

Zhang, Liuya. "Global Powers, Local Divides: Ethnic Status and Foreign Public Opinion Toward the U.S. and China in Postcolonial Multiethnic States." Under review, *British Journal of Political Science*.

Book Project and Working Papers

Zhang, Liuya. *In The Shadows of Imperialism: Postcolonial National Habitus, Identity, and Foreign Policy Orientation*. Dissertation/book manuscript in progress.

Zhang, Liuya. "Why Postimperial Security Alignments Recover: Imperial Trust and the Resilience of the U.S.–Philippine Alliance." Working paper; draft available on request.

Zhang, Liuya. "Neither Bloc nor Break: Boundary Awareness and Non-Alignment in Postcolonial Multiethnic States." Manuscript in development.

Zhang, Liuya. "Sovereignty for Whom? Ethnic Status and the Reception of Foreign-Backed Projects." Early-stage project.

Zhang, Liuya and Stephan Haggard. "North Korean Peace Proposals, 1998–2022: An Empirical Approach." Manuscript in revision.

Published Research, Translation, and Policy Writing

Haggard, Stephan, and **Zhang, Liuya**. 2024. "China-DPRK Trade: What Do We Know?" *National Committee on North Korea Issue Briefs*.

Haggard, Stephan, and **Zhang, Liuya**. 2020. "Researching a Hard Target: Analyzing North Korea with Official Economic Data." *North Korea Economic Forum Working Paper Series*, Vol. 2.

Park, Tae Gyun. 2018. 韩国现代史：十个代表性事件的深度解读 [*Korean Modern History: An In-depth Analysis of Ten Representative Events*]. Translated by Liju Xing and **Liuya Zhang**. Fudan University Press.

Public Commentary

With MESO Lab Members. 2023. "In Memory of Bear Braumoeller." *The Duck of Minerva*, June 29.

Zhang, Liuya and Stephan Haggard. 2021. "Career Paths to the North Korean Politburo Part 3: Personalism, New Directions and Reading the Tea Leaves." *The Peninsula*, September 15.

Zhang, Liuya and Stephan Haggard. 2021. "Career Paths to the North Korean Politburo Part 2: Toward Military-Civilian Fusion?" *The Peninsula*, September 13.

Zhang, Liuya and Stephan Haggard. 2021. "Career Paths to the North Korean Politburo Part 1: Trends under Kim Jong-un." *The Peninsula*, September 8.

Haggard, Stephan, and **Zhang, Liuya**. 2020. "When Pyongyang Says Peace, Prepare for Provocation." *Asia Times*, August 7.

Haggard, Stephan, and **Zhang, Liuya**. 2020. "North Korean Peace Proposals: A Long-Run View." *The Peninsula*, July 1.

Haggard, Stephan, and **Zhang, Liuya**. 2020. "The China-Russia Security Council Resolution Part 2: Chinese Motives." *The Peninsula*, July 29.

Haggard, Stephan, and **Zhang, Liuya**. 2020. "The China-Russia Security Council Resolution Part 1: Sanctions Relief." *The Peninsula*, July 28.

Awards, Fellowships, and Grants

The Ohio State University

WAC Outstanding Writing Instruction Award, Center for the Study and Teaching of Writing, 2025. ($200)

Madison Scott Award for Best Graduate Student Paper on Race and Ethnic Politics, Department of Political Science, 2024. Awarded for an earlier version of "Global Powers, Local Divides." ($500)

Mershon Center Graduate Research Grant, 2023–2024. Dissertation data collection. ($5,000)

Political Science Department Competition Grant, 2023–2024. Dissertation data collection. ($3,200)

Program in Statistics and Methodology Junior Fellow, 2022–2023.

University Fellow, 2020–2021.

Summer Fellowship, Division of Social and Behavioral Sciences, 2020–2026.

UC San Diego

Ruth Adams Award for Best Analytic Writing Research Paper, 2020. Awarded for an early version of "North Korean Peace Proposals, 1998–2022." ($1,000)

Seoul National University

POSCO Asia Fellowship, 2015–2018.

Scholastic Achievement Award, 2018.

Fudan University

National Scholarship, Korea Foundation Scholarship, Outstanding Graduate, and university scholarships, 2012–2015.

Research Experience

Modeling Emergent Social Order (MESO) Lab, The Ohio State University 2022–Present
Research Fellow, National Science Foundation–funded MESO Lab project, founded by the late Bear F. Braumoeller. Continued as an independent research fellow under NSF funding following his passing in May 2023. Led theory development, research design, and empirical analysis for an article on China's recognition dilemma, as well as the preparation of project progress reports

UC San Diego 2019–2020
Research Assistant for Stephan Haggard. Contributed to research on Korean security, China-DPRK relations, sanctions diplomacy, democratic backsliding, and regional counterterrorism.

UC San Diego 2018–2019
Research Assistant for Tai Ming Cheung. Contributed to research on East Asian security, Chinese technology and defense policy, military-civil fusion, and China-DPRK relations; served as liaison for the 2019 Northeast Asia Cooperation Dialogue.

Fudan University 2013–2018
Research Assistant for Liju Xing. Contributed to research and translation projects on Korean politics, modern Korean history, Korean Confucianism, and China-Korea cultural exchange.

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record

POLITSC 3910: Identity Politics, The Ohio State University, Spring 2025. Overall instructor effectiveness: 4.81/5.00. Course received Ohio State's Outstanding Writing Instruction Award.

POLITSC 3780: Data Literacy and Visualization, The Ohio State University, Fall 2023. Hybrid course using R for exploratory data analysis and visualization.

Teaching Assistant

POLITSC 7552: Quantitative Political Analysis, The Ohio State University, Spring 2022. Led weekly recitations for graduate students. Instructor: Sunny Yang.

GPPS 400: International Relations of the Asia-Pacific, UC San Diego, Winter 2020. Instructor: Stephan Haggard.

IRGN 408: Korean Security, UC San Diego, Winter 2020. Instructor: Stephan Haggard.

Conference Presentations

Midwest Political Science Association, International Studies Association, American Political Science Association, and 10th Annual New-Wave Realism Conference, 2025. Presented dissertation theory and Korea-Japan and Philippines-U.S. case research.

International Relations Theory Colloquium, organized by Jennifer Mitzen and Sebastian Rosato, 2024. Presented dissertation theory chapter.

Midwest Political Science Association, 2022. Presented early version of the ethnic-status and great-power public opinion project.

American Political Science Association and International Security Seminar, United States Military Academy at West Point, 2022. Presented early version of the China recognition-dilemma project.

North Korea Economic Forum Annual Conference, 2020. Presented research on North Korean data sources, methods, and pitfalls.

Fudan University Korean Studies Graduate Conference, 2017. Presented research on North Korea's views of nuclear weapons under Kim Il Sung.

Korean Peninsula Policy Consensus, Seoul National University, 2016. Presented research on the delayed U.S. troop withdrawal from South Korea, 1948–1949.

Professional Training and Service

Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research, Syracuse University, Summer 2023. Coursework in interpretive methods, interpretation and history, and ethnographic methods.

Graduate Student Peer Mentor, Department of Political Science, The Ohio State University, 2022–2023.

Coordinator, Research in International Relations Seminar, The Ohio State University, 2022–2023.

President, Hibiscus Korean Language Association, Fudan University, 2014–2015.

Methods, Software, and Languages

Methods: survey research and causal inference; statistical modeling; computational text analysis; inferential network analysis; process tracing and comparative-historical analysis; mixed-method research design; GIS and remote sensing.

Software: Python; R; Stata; LaTeX; ArcGIS; Google Earth Engine Code Editor; NetLogo.

Languages: Proficient in Chinese, English, and Korean; intermediate Japanese.

References

Christopher Gelpi
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The Ohio State University
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Professor of Political Science
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